# RESEARCH INFORMED CONSENT FORM

**STUDY TITLE:** Language Learning Study (Online) (IRB-FY2025-10331)

**INVESTIGATOR(S):** Alec Marantz; Marianne Azar

## INVITATION TO BE A PART OF A RESEARCH STUDY

You are invited to participate in a research study. This form has information to help you decide whether or not you wish to participate - please review it carefully. Your participation is voluntary. Please ask any questions you have about the study or about this form before deciding to participate.

## PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The purpose of this study is to test how we learn and apply rules in language learning as we read new complex words. We are interested in how the mind processes those new words being learned, each with different characteristics, during the experiment.

## ELIGIBILITY TO PARTICIPATE

You are eligible to participate in this study if you speak English fluently and have done so before the age of 7 and are 18 years or older.

You should not participate if you learned English later than at 7 years old.

To determine if you are eligible, we will ask you to complete a questionnaire with your language background.

## DESCRIPTION OF STUDY PROCEDURES

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

1. Read through this consent form and click the button below to agree to participate in this study.
2. You will then be redirected to an introduction and instructions to the experiment.
3. You will be shown or will hear various sentences with new words in them. You will be asked to retain their general meaning (place or thing). In the training block, you may sometimes be asked whether new word in the sentence indicated a place or thing (a focus trial).
4. After each training block comes a test block: based on what have learned about the meanings of the new words you encountered, you will judge if their usage in new sentences in this test block makes sense or not. (e.g., if the new word is HAMMER, “the hammer is closed on Tuesdays” would not make sense.).

5. Finally, you will sort those learned words between places and things.
6. Each practice-test-sort block covers 12-14 words and takes 4-6 minutes, for a total of 6 blocks. All in all, this takes around 30 minutes.
7. Upon completing the experiment, you will be redirected to Prolific. You will receive payment via the Prolific platform after the study is fully complete by all participants.

**RISKS OR DISCOMFORTS**

This study involves the following risks or discomforts: While there are measures put in place by the researcher to secure data, there is always a risk of a potential breach of confidentiality. You may be made unaware of or misled about some information regarding the nature and purpose of the study. However, you will be debriefed about this as soon as you finish the experiment.

Please tell the researchers if you believe you are harmed from your participation in the study.

**BENEFITS**

It is hoped that this study will contribute to knowledge about how words are learned under uncertain conditions, which is currently understudied, despite being commonly found across virtually all languages.

While there are no direct benefits to the participant, participants will be helping expand our knowledge of how language is learned and will learn more about the study of neurolinguistics.

**COMPENSATION**

You will receive $7.5 (USD) via Prolific for your participation.

**VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION**

Participating in this study is completely voluntary. You may choose not to take part in the study or to stop participating at any time, for any reason, without penalty or negative consequences.

If you withdraw or are withdrawn from the study early, then we will not keep information about you that is already collected.

**PRIVACY & DATA CONFIDENTIALITY**

In this study, you may be asked to provide information that could be used to identify you personally. This information will be kept confidential. Only researchers and others that will keep the information confidential (e.g., regulatory agencies or oversight groups) may access information that could personally identify you.

*Future Use of Data*

Information about you collected for this study may be shared with other researchers, used for other research studies, or placed in a data repository. These studies may be similar to this study or completely different. All information that could identify you will be removed before sharing the data or using it for other research studies. We will not ask you for additional permission before sharing the information.

## ACCESS TO YOUR STUDY INFORMATION

We will not give you access to the information that is collected about you in this study.

## CONTACT INFORMATION

You are encouraged to ask questions at any time during this study. For information about the study, contact Marianne Azar at (646) 986-2548, ma6449@nyu.edu, or their faculty sponsor, Alec Marantz at (212) 998-7950, ma988@nyu.edu.

If you have questions about your rights as a research participant or if you believe you have been harmed from the research, please contact the NYU Human Research Protection Program at (212)998-4808 or ask.humansubjects@nyu.edu.

## AGREEMENT TO PARTICIPATE

By checking below, you are agreeing to participate in this study. Make sure you understand what the study involves before you agree. If you have questions about the study after you agree to participate, you can contact the research team using the information provided above. You may [print/keep] a copy of this form.

[ ] *I agree to participate in this research study.*